

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender | Security Architecture | CISSP

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer and Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience owning security controls, incident response, threat monitoring, and vulnerability management across hybrid Windows Server and Microsoft Azure environments. I have strong hands-on expertise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Single Sign-On (SSO), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID Conditional Access. I have delivered security programmes across complex, multi-site organisations and I work effectively with Infrastructure Operations and wider technology teams to identify vulnerabilities, strengthen security posture, and respond to incidents. I take ownership of cybersecurity controls and security architecture, translating risk findings into actionable remediation plans and ensuring alignment with frameworks including ISO 27001, NIST, and Cyber Essentials Plus.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Monitoring:** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL); CrowdStrike Falcon Next Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM); detection rule development; Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; Microsoft Defender Vulnerability Management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID; Conditional Access policies; MFA; Single Sign-On (SSO); BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 IR lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat hunting; alert triage; containment, eradication and recovery
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Windows and Azure Infrastructure Security:** Windows Server security hardening; Azure security configuration; hybrid cloud security architecture
- **Endpoint and Email Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR; Mimecast; Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM; Tanium
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR automation; security workflow development
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Own cybersecurity controls and security architecture for UAL's hybrid IT estate, supporting 8,000 users across multiple sites, and ensuring alignment with ISO 27001, NIST, and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks
- Administer and optimise Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, authoring and tuning KQL detection analytics, configuring workbooks, and integrating threat intelligence to improve threat monitoring fidelity and reduce false positive rates
- Lead incident response investigations following the NIST 800-61 framework; conduct threat hunting using MITRE ATT&CK mapping to proactively identify threats across Windows Server and Azure infrastructure
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), deploying and tuning policies across endpoints and hybrid identity environments, and ensuring comprehensive security telemetry flows into Sentinel

- Administer Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement, and SSO configuration to reduce identity-based risk
- Lead vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), prioritising and coordinating remediation of penetration testing findings with infrastructure and operations teams
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to enforce least-privilege access and audit privileged sessions across critical systems
- Automate security operations workflows via PowerShell scripting and SOAR playbooks, reducing mean time to detect and respond to security incidents

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an 8,000-device Windows estate, including policy configuration, alert triage, and integration with Microsoft Sentinel for centralised monitoring
- Developed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel KQL analytics rules and automated response playbooks, improving detection coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud workloads
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM platform, removing standing privileged access from over 200 accounts and strengthening the organisation's identity security posture
- Delivered regular vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-prioritised reports and tracking remediation through to confirmed closure
- Configured and maintained Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA and SSO policies for staff and students, reducing credential-based attack risk
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon EDR operations, managing Prevent policies, exclusions, and response containment actions in coordination with IT operations
- Managed Mimecast email security controls, including anti-phishing, anti-spoofing and impersonation protection policies
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance and Cyber Essentials Plus certification activities, evidencing control effectiveness and preparing audit documentation

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented endpoint security controls and MDM policies across a cloud-first SaaS environment, including Windows Server and Azure infrastructure hardening
- Monitored security alerts, conducted initial triage, and escalated incidents in line with defined incident response procedures
- Supported Azure AD identity and access management, including SSO and MFA configuration for a hybrid workforce
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and contributed to penetration testing remediation tracking, ensuring findings were risk-prioritised and addressed within agreed timescales
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance activities, including evidence collection, policy review, and audit preparation

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint visibility and enabling proactive threat hunting through Sentinel integration
- Authored a comprehensive library of Microsoft Sentinel KQL detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, significantly improving threat monitoring coverage across identity, endpoint, and cloud workloads
- Designed and delivered BeyondTrust PAM controls for privileged access management, removing standing admin rights from over 200 accounts and substantially improving the organisation's identity security posture
- Drove Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) engagements, using continuous automated testing to identify and close critical gaps in security controls ahead of real-world exploitation

- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification, leading technical control verification and providing documented evidence of security posture improvements
- Reduced mean time to respond to security incidents by over 40% through SOAR playbook automation and streamlined incident response workflows within the Microsoft Sentinel environment

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)